MOUNTAINEER

Fall 1996 Volume 1 Issue 1

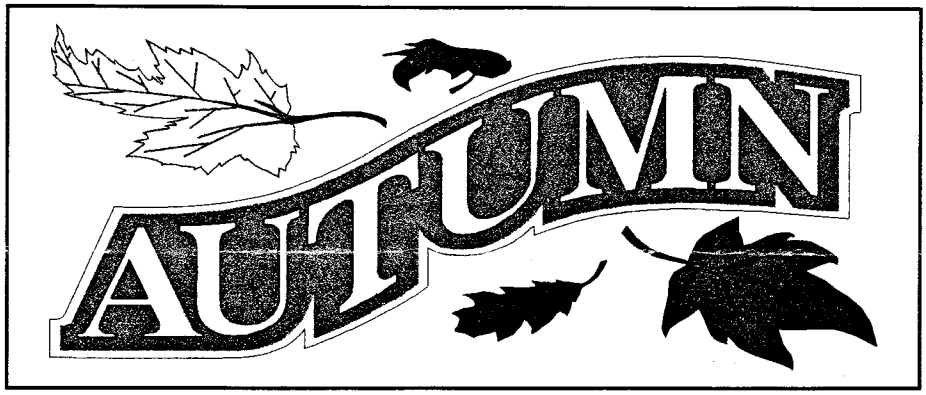
NEW CMA BOARD & OFFICERS

On September 7 the Board of Directors met and elected their new officers for this year. The following people will make up the new Board: Jackson Bain, Roland Siushansian, Janice Dring, Tim Black, Anne Marie Doppman, Carroll Yingling, Lee Weinberger. Jackson has agreed to be President again this year. Carroll has taken the position of Vice President. Roland has taken on the Treasurer's job. We are still looking for a Secretary. If anyone would be interested in filling this position, contact Jackson or Carroll please.

SNOW REMOVAL

CMA has the responsibility to keep the roads passable during the winter months. This means we need to keep on top of snow and ice removal. It is the responsibility of each homeowner to arrange for the clearing of his or her own driveway.

Call Alice Minnamon if you wish to be part of a group effort to have a contract with Donnie Stotler. Donnie has been doing snow removal for us for several years now. Usually the cost is $10 for each plowing. Deeper snows may run $20 and $30 in rare instances when a backhoe is needed. Donnie and Alice will confer on the times and places plowed. At the end of the season bills will be sent directly to each homeowner.



FALL WILDINGS BY PAT WATERS

It has been a beautiful, bountiful wild flower summer in our very special corner of West Virginia. The Lilies, Black-eyed Susans and Queen Anne's Lace have been spectacular.

I'm sure you have all been aware of the eye-catching plantings on the median strips of Rt 70. First we had Daisies and Larkspur, followed by Sweet Rocket and Poppies and then came the Cosmos and Cone Flowers. Now, we are ready for fall and there are lots of treats in store for you. Traveler's Joy (wild clematis) with it's lovely scent is trailing over fences and shrubs. The Sumac seed pods are showing beautiful color and the leaves are colorful too. Deadly Nightshade, which had deep purple flowers in the summer, now has clusters of berries, green turning to red. The Jack-in-the-Pulpit now sports clusters of red berries. In England, they are called Lords and Ladies. Teasels are everywhere. They are very prickly but are very effective in dried flower arrangements. Dried Curly Dock does well in fall bouquets. One of my favorite vines is Bittersweet with its orange and red berries. Some people call it a pest but to me it is lovely. Poison ivy has become very colorful. It's used in England in herbaceous borders. The many Golden Rods are everywhere. They are not the culprits for hay fever victims as many people think. It is Ragweed that is the irritant. Joe Pye Weed (named for an Indian) is four to six feet tall and has a cluster of dull pink flowers. Pokeberries are turning a deep purple now. They were used to dye clothes back in Colonial times. The small purple and white Asters are blooming all along the roadsides.

Look around and you may see all these beautiful plants and some other beauties too.

BOARD MEMBER CORNER

Each newsletter, a member of the Board of Directors will have a column here to write about something of interest to them and the community. Our first guest writer is Carroll Yingling Jr.

Phyllis and I have enjoyed the mountainside since moving into our house (Schonewald - J2) in August 1990. A part of our joy has been sharing the wonders of the Cacapon Mountains and its flora and fauna with our twin granddaughters.

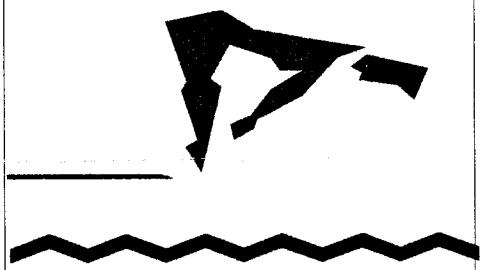
Now, eleven years old, they love to lead the way, scampering up the Blue Trail or the White Trail (their favorite). A part of every trek for us is a discussion of what we are seeing...the common blue violet, the pipsissewa, the pileated woodpecker, or the eastern ring-necked snake.....and how we are feeling...exhilarated, or tired, curious...and how we are connected to all the plants, insects and animals that we met along the way.

I guess I am trying to pass on to Kate and Taylor a truth that means a lot to me. That is that trees, rocks, flowers and small creatures with whom I share space on this earth, have certain rights, and that I have a responsibility to care for them just as I care for my children and grandchildren.

Needless to say, I am pleased to be a part of a community that strives to regard and protect its environs.

WHO CAN YOU TURN TO?

Are you confused and looking for someone to help you with house cleaning, window washing, odd jobs, tree clean up etc.? We can help. Linda Clark and Pat Schenk published a survey on mountainside helpers and contractors. Call Pat (703-719-5499), Kitty or Gale Connor (304-258-3975) or Alice Minnamon (304-258-5352) for names and numbers of reliable people.



SWIMMING POOL

This past summer our CMA pool attendance increased significantly over past years. Many more people enjoyed the quiet whispers of the waterfall and surrounding forest. However, it also became apparent that our system of green and red badges and purchasing of white tickets for individual owners has become cumbersome and difficult to administer. Homeowners have lost badges, failed to pass them on to new homeowners or just do not bring them to the pool.

A pool committee (a sub committee of the Recreation Committee) is being formed to review the system in accordance with membership guidelines. We need to make identification more efficient in order to defray operating costs. If you would like to be on the Pool Committee contact: Charlie Balkan

SEPTIC TANK INFORMATION

By now Alice Minnamon should have contacted you if your septic tank is in need of cleaning. Every homeowner has two septic tanks enabling the discharge to pass through two stage before entering the central sewer system to the wetlands. To ensure that no solids escape the two-tank stages and contaminate the wetlands above state regulated acceptance levels, homes that are heavily used need to have their septic tanks pumped every 3-5 years. Infrequently used homes can be done every 6-8, years, subject to inspection every 5 years.

Floyd Beddow charges $136 plus tax per tank. There are extra one-time charges if he must locate, dig to uncover lids and install manholes. Installation of manholes make subsequent pumpings easier and less costly.

SPECIAL EVENTS

MAKE SURE THAT YOUR CALENDAR IS MARKED FOR THE FALL OF 1997 TO HELP US CELEBRATE COOLFONT MOUNTAINSIDE ASSOCIATION'S 25TH ANNIVERSARY.

APPOINTMENT OF COMMITTEE CHAIRS

At the Board meeting in September the following people were appointed to chair the various committees that make CMA work.

DACC: Linda Clark

FINANCE: Bob Dowling

NOMINATING:Dick Lehman

RECREATION: Charles Balkan
Pool, tennis courts, barn, all fun and sport facilities

UTILITIES: Gale Connor
Water & sewer upgrade, operations, maintenance, regulatory affairs and billing

COMMUNICATION:
Rosemary Bigelow
Newsletter, welcome packs, board notices and mailings, community outreach, liaison with neighboring communities and organizations

SOCIAL: Joan Bradfield
Community gatherings, board-meeting pot luck suppers, events, 25th Anniversary planning

COVENANTS/BYLAWS:
Tim Black
Review of legal issues & recommendations on updates to governance documents

SAFETY:
Elmer Broxson
Security issues, fire safety and emergency planning.

All of the committees are in need of support. Please call the committee chair if you would like to volunteer to help. If you are one of the lucky families that have been here for 25 years, why not give Eva Lehman a call and say you'd like to help.

POOL PARTY

The end of the year pool picnic/barbecue party was held over Labor Day. The sky was blue, the weather was beautiful, and the pool was very inviting to the people who came to celebrate or mourn the end of the summer. There was lots of food and lots of lively conversations to go around. There were more people here than last year's pool party so we can consider it a success and everyone had a great time.

Were **you** there?

POT LUCK

We hope by now everyone knows that there is going to be a pot luck dinner after every Board of Directors meeting. The first one on September 7 was held in our barn in Coolfont and was a very successful one. We had so much food we could have fed a lot more people. We had everything from salads to main dishes to desserts and wine and beer. But most importantly, we had a good time. There were at least twenty-five people there.

We hope to have more of the community at the next one. Contact Joan Bradfield for information (301-984-9657)

DIRECTORY

Have you sent your form for the new directory in yet? If not, please do it as soon as possible. If you need another form, call Mary Ann Siushansian (301-774-2738, or 304-258-6384) and she will mail one to you.

A VIEW FROM THE PRESIDENT

Dear Mountainside Neighbors,

I don't know about you, but Autumn is my favorite time at Coolfont. The Apple Butter Festival, the changing leaves, the activities of our wildlife neighbors as they get ready for winter, all add to the already year-round sense of peace and perfection.

It's also time we take stock of the challenges for keeping our community solid and solvent. We have begun with a fine new Board of Directors, all eager to get to work. The Board has approved a fine list of chairs for the various committees.

All volunteers are being encouraged to lend a hand to help each of these. As with any volunteer-powered organization, CMA's success in getting where we need to go this year depends totally on that engine -- volunteers. Please spare some time and energy for the mountainside in whatever capacity you choose.

Finally, let's get together frequently. One of the benefits of being in a community like Coolfont, is the pleasure of meeting new friends, and sharing the pleasures of this beautiful place with each other.

I believe it's going to be a great year. See you on the mountainside!

Jackson

NO OPEN BURNING ON MOUNTAINSIDE

With the advent of Autumn, and the falling leaves, it is a good time to review the CMA rules about having any open fires.

The regulations state:

"CMA's Development and Architectural Control Committee regulations strictly prohibit open burning because of the danger of a forest fire on our wooded mountainside.

Exterior fires are permitted in barbecue receptacles. Barbecue receptacles are defined as factory manufactured metal enclosures, such as a barbecue grill or portable metal exterior fireplace. These receptacles should be in good shape, i.e., not rusting out or containing holes for sparks to escape. Those in disrepair shall be replaced. DACC approved, and permanently installed stone or brick barbecues with chimneys and spark arresters are also permitted. Barbecue receptacles must be certified by the DACC and may require re-certification from time to time. Open fires on or in the ground are not permitted under any circumstances."

The message here is simple: Don't start a bonfire on the mountainside, even if it is on your own property. None of us can afford to replace all that would be lost if a fire started here.

GENERAL INFO

Please make sure that any letters for CMA are sent to our PO Box. The address is:

PO Box 418
Berkeley Springs WV 25411

general info (continued)

If you would like to have a copy of the Board of Directors minutes, please contact:

Bob Lemon
310 1/2 N. Washington St.
Berkeley Springs, WV 25411
304-258-2007

IMPORTANT DATES TO REMEMBER

The Board of Directors has set the dates for the meetings for the year. Please mark your calenders and we hope to see you at some of these meetings. All meetings will be held in Coolfont at various members homes. Please call any of the Board members to find out where the meetings are going to be held. There will be some kind of social event after most board meetings.

Nov. 2: 10:00
at the Siushansian's Q-3
7:30 pm: pot luck dessert at Joan Bradfield's N-2. We will be having our first game/puzzle night. Bring a favorite game to play or a puzzle. We hope to see you there.

No board meeting in December

Jan. 11 10:00
Place to be announced.

Feb. 8 10:00
Place to be announced

Mar. 8 10:00
Place to be announced

Apr. 12 10:00
Place to be announced

(continued on next column)

important dates (continued)

May 10 10:00
Place to be announced

June 14 10:00
Place to be announced

July 19 9:00 Board meeting
Place to be announced
Annual meeting 1:00
Treetops



WELCOME NEW CMA MEMBERS

Let's give a warm CMA welcome to three new families here on the mountainside. If you live near them either in Coolfont or your home, why not stop by and welcome them.

Mr. & Mrs. Frank Rutherford III
300 East Seminary Street
Mercersburg, PA 17236
Coolfont: H-6 & H-7

Richard Picardi
4221 Rainer Avenue
Mt. Rainer, MD 20712
Coolfont: E-9

George & Rosemary Lardner
5604 32nd Street, NW
Washington, DC 20015
202-363-2142 (home)
Coolfont L-4

SOCIAL COMMITTEE IDEAS

The Social Committee, chaired by Joan Bradfield with members Leila Keese, Eva Lehman, Mary Ann Siushansian and Pat Waters have come up with some great ideas for social events to hold on the mountainside. The goal of the committee is to have some kind of social gathering every month. Some of the ideas are:

**Pot luck dinners after every board meeting (we have already had 2 successful ones)

**A easy nature walk led by Charlie Balkan

**Interactive murder mystery play; there would be a charge for this.

**Musical evening presented by the Bakkegards; there would be a charge for this.

**Square dancing, line dancing or just an old fashioned dance.

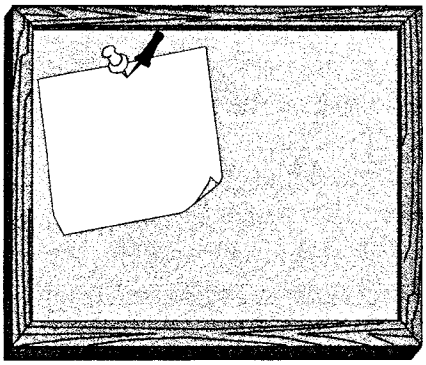
**Game/puzzle night (coming up after November board meeting).

**Pool party to open and close the pool.

**Breakfast at Treetops; compliments of Sam Ashelman.

**25th Anniversary party

If you have any other ideas or suggestions, or would like to host a get together, why not call Joan or one of the members of the committee.



COMMUNITY BULLETIN BOARD

Do you have some news that the community would like to know, is your house or lot for sale, are you celebrating a big event? Let us know. Get in touch with Mary Ann Siushansian to put your news here.

If you know someone who would like to purchase a lot and or home here in Coolfont, here's what's for sale:

HOUSES FOR SALE

Q-9 Montebello.....$196,500
K-5 Shalom.....$135,000
I-2 &I-3 Brickless.. $174,900
E-1 Tamarack.....$119,500
K-8 Fox's Den.....$144,900
B-5 & B-4 Katydid...$ 99,500
G-4 Wings.....$127,500

LOTS FOR SALE

E-3.....$ 33,000
K-1.....$42,500
K-2.....$38,000
K-1 & K-2.....$78,000
S-6.....$68,950

bulletin board continued

Homeowners who rent privately and have expressed interest in joining together for advertising and referrals should call Eva Lehman.

IN MEMORIAM

Marvin Steinberg
October 14, 1996

Neighbor, Board Member, Friend

OCTOBER BOARD MEETING

The Board met on October 12 at the home of Roland and Mary Ann Siushansian. The calendar was set for the year (see page 4).

Among the other items of business discussed were water bills and past due assessments. Only a few are outstanding, and letters will be sent. Homeowners who suffer extraordinary water usage due to leaks should be notified of CMA policy concerning water bill adjustments (see article on page 6).

In other business, DACC and CMA are required to follow CABO and state of West Virginia regulations for site and building approvals for new homes or additions. The water upgrade project is moving ahead on schedule, despite tough digging in rock fields.

The Communications Committee is ready with the first newsletter (Here it is!) and "Welcome Wagon" packages for new home/lot owners are being put together. The Social Committee is planning lots of events (see this page).

WATER BILL UPDATE

The West Virginia PSC has issued the following new guidelines for late payment of water bills. Please make sure you read this information.

1st day: Bill is issued

21st day: Bill is late & may be subject to a late charge

31st day: Bill is 1 day late

40th day: Unpaid bill is 10 days delinquent

41st day: Water provides the customer with a written notice that bill is 10 or more days delinquent and service will be discontinued on or before the 52nd day.

46th day: Notice of termination posted for termination of master meter, apartment buildings or for any service where the service address is not the same as mailing address.

51st day: Discontinuance may occur once an attempt at personal contact at door allowing customer to pay in full. Failure to answer door, does not prevent the utility from disconnecting.

30 days after: Written notice of pending discontinuance is void.

(continued in next column)
(water bill update continued)

Once a deferred payment has been entered into and customer fails to meet the terms of the deferred payment the utility can only terminate after giving written notice by first class mail at least five calendar days excluding postal holidays prior to the water utility terminating service, personal contact or telephone contact may be substituted.

WATER USE POLICY

The CMA Board passed a policy resolution last year to deal with the loss of extraordinary amounts of water due to leaks or other causes. Because this causes enormous water bills, the Board adopted the following policy:

"All water usage from the meter to and inside the home is the responsibility of the homeowner. Leaks can occur for any number of reasons, but it remains the homeowners' responsibility to look for and prevent potential leak causing conditions from occurring. A CMA homeowner who suffers extraordinary water loss for any reason in a given meter-reading period (one quarter) may write to the Board of Directors to request an adjustment on the resulting water bill for that period.

It is the intention of this adjustment formula to encourage the homeowner

(water policy continued)

to quickly correct and/or prevent such conditions. The Board may, at its discretion, grant the following relief to the homeowner: the water bill will be recalculated for a total of twice the normal usage (the average of usage for the same quarter in each of the past two years, if data is available) at $23 per thousand gallons, plus usage over this amount at a rate representing the incremental cost for pumping and treatment, currently set by the West Virginia Public Service Commission at 75 cents per thousand gallons."

An example of how the policy would be applied: an average homeowner who typically uses about 5,000 gallons in a given quarter each year, might have an undetected leak and receive a bill for 30,000 gallons, or 6 times normal usage, resulting in a bill of $690 at the current water rate. The adjusted bill would be for 10,000 gallons (twice normal) at $23 per thousand, plus 20,000 gallons at 75 cents per thousand. The adjusted bill would be $245.

Want to stop leaks? Winterize your home (heat low, pipes protected, outside spigots turned off inside)! Check your toilet flaps for proper seal frequently (put food color in tank, check bowl for leak a day or so later)! Watch for dripping (even slow dripping) faucets! Water is a precious resource on the mountainside; let's help preserve it!

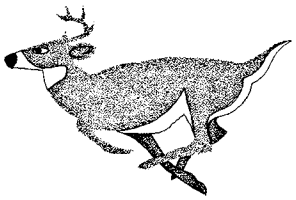
MOUNTAIN DISCOVERIES

In every newsletter read about something that's going on in the area by one of our mountainsiders.

A visit to the Needle and Eye located at 707 South Washington St., next to the Carousel, will be a delightful experience. Greta Weinberger owns and operates the shop and is a full-time resident at Coolfont. Not only will you be able to find a large selection of designer needlepoint canvases, yarns, counted thread cross stitch fabrics, kits, and accessories, but there is also a magnificent doll house. This doll house was built by Greta's husband, Lee, and furnished and decorated with painstaking care by Greta. It is truly a sight to behold. **See if you can find the unexploded bomb in Greta's shop.**

After visiting the Needle and Eye, walk next door and take a look at the unbelievable amount of crafts and knickknacks available in the Carousel. It is filled with crafts made by local artists; and be sure to go upstairs to the Christmas shop. The Carousel is located in a 1900's Sears house.

These two shops should be on your must see list in Berkeley Springs.



WARNING: HUNTING SEASON

Hunting season has begun for small game. Unfortunately, CMA has experienced an afternoon of gun fire in late September very near our property. At times, we felt that the shooting was on Mountainside property. Deer season will open Nov. 26 and end Dec. 7 so be aware that there will be an increase in hunting during that time. Always wear bright colored clothing when hiking on trails that adjoin CMA or extend into the state forest. Hopefully, this will help keep us from being mistaken for one of our four footed friends. Call 1-800-638-4263 if you think there is shooting on the mountainside or in the adjoining state park.



CMA NEWSLETTER
C/O Mary Ann Siushansian
17302 Parson Grove Terrace
Olney, MD 20832

inside... LOTS OF NEW INFORMATION,
EXCITING THINGS ARE HAPPENING ON THE MOUNTAINSIDE
CHECK IT ALL OUT